



Welcome to Family Access

A gentle window into the everyday life of your relative at Whiteley Village.

VILLAGE VOICE · FAMILY GUIDE

What this is, and what it isn't

Family Access is a small, quiet companion platform — designed to keep you in touch with your relative's world at Whiteley Village without intruding on their independence.

You don't get to see everything they do, and you won't be reading their private messages. What you do get is a calm view of community life — what's on, what's been shared, how the village is doing — and a way to reach them, and the people looking after them, when you'd like to.

Your relative remains the author of their own life. We're simply making it easier to stay close.

What you'll see

When you sign in, you'll find:



News

Village announcements, updates from the trust, things you'd want to know about.



Events

What's on at the village — concerts, garden mornings, talks. Helpful for knowing what your relative might be enjoying.



Notice Board

The everyday business of village life — lost cat, swap of plants, neighbour's milestone — quietly shared.



Stories

Residents sharing memories, observations, and reflections. A quiet pleasure to dip into.



Wellbeing Notes

A shared space where you and your relative's circle can note small things that help — preferences, sensitivities, what cheers them up.



Quick contact

One-tap to call or message your relative, and a separate route to reach a community operator if you'd rather speak to someone in the village.



Alerts

If something urgent happens, you'll receive a notification on your phone — even if the platform isn't open. See below for the iPhone note.

Getting set up

Three steps. None of them complicated. Take them at whatever pace suits you.



Register

Visit whiteley.voicevillage.co.uk, tap **Family Access** → at the bottom of the welcome page, then **New to Family Access? Register here**. Fill in your details and your relative's name — that's how we connect you to them.

2

Verify your email

We'll send you a short email — just tap the green button inside it. That confirms you're you, not someone pretending to be a relative.

3

Wait for approval

An administrator at the village will check your registration and approve it. You'll receive a second email — this one inviting you to sign in. Usually within a day or two.

If you're using an iPhone — please read this

Apple's iPhone has an unusual rule about notifications from websites: they only arrive if the website has been **added to your Home Screen first**. Without this step, alerts won't reach you — silently. We don't know they didn't arrive, and neither do you.

It's a quick one-time step:

1. Open Village Voice in Safari on your iPhone
2. Tap the **Share** button at the bottom (the square with an upward arrow)
3. Scroll down and tap **Add to Home Screen**
4. Tap Add

From then on, open Village Voice using the icon on your Home Screen — not from Safari. That's all.

If you'd rather not, you can still use Family Access — you simply won't receive push notifications. Other features work as normal.

About alerts

You'll occasionally receive notifications on your phone. We've been deliberate about this — we will never bombard you with trivia. Notifications are reserved for moments when something genuinely matters.

The most important is the **emergency alert**. If your relative triggers an emergency from within Village Voice, you'll receive a clear notification on your device. This is in **addition** to any 999 call they make — not instead of it. Emergency services are always the first response; you are kept informed.

This is one of the genuine reasons we ask iPhone users to add the platform to their Home Screen. Without that step, an emergency notification has nowhere to land.

About privacy

Your relative remains in charge of what they share. Family Access is read-only for most things — you can see what the village publishes, what your relative chooses to post, and what's been agreed to be visible to family.

You **will not** see your relative's:

- Private messages or notes
- Medical profile or detailed health information
- Day-to-day location or movements
- Diary entries or personal recordings

You **will** see what would feel natural to be shared with a thoughtful relative — community news, events, stories the village has shared, the general rhythm of life. The Wellbeing Notes are a shared space where you and your relative's circle can add small things that help — never replacing your relative's own voice, but adding to it.

About the trial

Village Voice and Family Access are in trial phase. During the trial, **Family Access is free** — you won't be asked to pay. The platform will move to a small subscription in due course, and we'll give you plenty of notice before that happens.

If you'd like to give us feedback during the trial — a feature you wish existed, something confusing, something that delighted you — please tell us. You're shaping how this becomes.

If you need help

If something isn't working, or you'd just like to talk to someone:

- Email us at enquiries@voicevillage.co.uk
- Or use **Quick contact** inside the platform to reach a village operator

We answer in plain language. If we don't yet have an answer, we'll tell you that too.

Village Voice is a small platform with a simple aim: to keep senior people connected to family and community in a way that's gentle, honest, and on their terms.

Made with care by **VoiceVillage** · Whiteley Village trial